

Captain Mira and the Little Moon

Pirate story • 3-4 years old



Salt wind tickled Captain Mira's nose. She wore a bright red scarf and a big, brave smile. Her ship, the Little Moon, rocked like a cradle on the blue, blue sea.

« **Today we sail slow,** » Mira said. Her crew giggled. « **We have a quiet plan.** »

The sea glinted. The sun felt warm on their cheeks. Little waves slapped the hull. The gulls sang above. Mira loved the sound of the sea. She loved the feel of the rope in her hands. She loved the hush before an island.

They had a map with a tiny dot. The dot hid a small cove. Mira wanted a secret stopover. « **We will be very careful,** » she told the crew. « **We will be kind and quiet and quick.** »

The Little Moon glided past foam. Clouds played catch with the sun. A soft breeze moved the flags. Mira watched the sky. She listened to each creak of the wood. She counted the waves, slow and steady. One, two, three. One, two, three.

Suddenly, a gentle fog hugged the ship. The world became soft and white. The crew held hands. Mira took a deep breath. « **We can do this,** » she said. Her voice was calm like warm tea. The fog smelled like salt and wild flowers. It felt like a cotton blanket.

Mira used her cleverness. She read the map, she felt the wind, she felt the tide. She hummed a little tune. The crew hummed with her. The tune helped them feel safe. The fog was not scary. It was only quiet. They moved like a fox, careful and light.

At the helm, Mira peered through the mist. A shadow of green appeared. « **Land!** » someone whispered. The Little Moon slipped into a small cove with smiling trees and smooth sand. Bright shells winked in the sun. Little crabs waved tiny claws. The crew cheered softly.

Mira tied the ship with a gentle knot. « **We will be quiet,** » she reminded everyone. They stepped onto the sand, shoes making soft prints. The island smelled of lemons and honey. Birds clapped their wings. Flowers brushed their

ankles.

Mira had a mission. They needed to find a hidden box with a meal for the crew. The map said « **Look where the two palms meet.** » Mira and her friends walked between two tall, leaning palms. They looked behind a rock. They listened to a friendly frog croak. « **It is here,** » Mira said, and her eyes shone.

They found a small wooden box. Inside were warm buns, sweet jam, and a tiny mug of cocoa. « **Hooray!** » the crew whispered. They ate slowly and shared. The buns tasted like sunshine. The jam tasted like summer. The cocoa smelled like hugs.

A little cloud rumbled, and a soft rain began. The crew moved under a big leaf. Mira wrapped her scarf around her shoulders. She smiled. « **A short rain,** » she said. The rain made the leaves sparkle. The crew danced a tiny dance. Rain tickled their noses. They laughed.

When the sky cleared, Mira checked the map again. « **Time to leave,** » she said. The Little Moon waited like a friend. Mira said goodbye to the island. She left their footprints, not heavy ones. She left only happy echoes.

Back on the ship, the crew sang. They sailed away with light hearts. Mira looked at the sea. She felt proud. She had been brave. She had been clever. She had been gentle. She had kept everyone safe.

As the sun slid down, the Little Moon rocked like a cradle. The stars came out to watch. Mira tucked her scarf in and whispered, « **Good night, little sea.** » The crew snuggled close. All was calm. All was bright. The adventure ended softly, and everyone slept, warm and happy.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who is the captain of the ship?

- Captain Mira
- Captain Tiger
- Captain Blue
- Captain Moon

2) Where did the crew find the small wooden box?

- Between two palms
- On a big mountain
- In the middle of the sea
- Under the ship

3) What did the crew eat from the box?

- Warm buns and jam
- Pizza and soda
- Ice cream and cake
- Apples and cheese

4) What happened while they were on the island?

- A little rain fell
- A big snowstorm came
- A loud thunder crashed
- It became very windy

Correct answers:

1) Captain Mira 2) Between two palms 3) Warm buns and jam 4) A little rain fell

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Cradle: A small bed that rocks gently to make someone feel safe and sleepy.

Glinted: Shone quickly with little bright flashes of light.

Hull: The strong bottom part of a boat that keeps it floating.

Cove: A small, quiet bay or curved beach between rocks.

Crew: A group of people who work together on the ship.

Helm: The wheel or place where someone steers the boat.

Fog: Thick, soft cloud that comes down low and makes things hard to see.

Tide: The slow rising and falling of the sea water at the shore.

Peered: Looked carefully or quietly to see something better.

Knot: A tie in rope that holds things together and keeps them safe.

Cocoa: A warm drink made from chocolate powder and milk or water.